ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapters 1–4: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land, The Pot Maker; Quality; vocation poems, Winds of Change; Canvas of Soil, Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** the learner bows to a young teacher	An elder honours a child.
2	**(d)** a gesture of trust that completes the passing of the craft	Trust allows growth.
3	**(c)** loss of cultural memory along with the craft	Craft carries memory.
4	**(c)** well-meaning but patronising	Anxious love.
5	**(c)** simile	Uses 'like'.
6	**(c)** a market that rewards show over skill	Commercial values.
7	**(b)** creativity found in ordinary labour	Gardening as creation.
8	**(c)** that old age equals incapacity	Ageism.
9	**(c)** does not suggest this; it only praises	No hatred is present.
10	**(c)** He said that good boots last long.	A general truth keeps the present.
11	**(b)** would have	Third conditional.
12	**(b)** Grandpa said that he had been fooling them all day.	Present perfect continuous becomes past perfect continuous.
13	**(b)** turn helplessness into resolve	Her emotion triggers action.
14	**(c)** it is held in trust for the community	Elders' view.
15	**(b)** history and society	Double meaning.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	She links a small event to larger ideas of learning and respect (1). Specific details make it believable and relevant to all (1).	1+1
17	It protects Sentila from hardship (1) but denies her chosen path and the community's craft (1).	1+1
18	It is a daily object so change is easy to see (1). Its shift from use to decor mirrors cultural shifts (1).	1+1
19	We know more than Ravi and Mother (1). The gap creates humour and exposes their misjudgement (1).	1+1
20	Both set out with a wish and change course thoughtfully (1). Both find happiness in a choice beyond self (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	The grandmother faced fear and age (1). The narrator's skill was needed too (1). Courage drove the process, but both were required (1).	1+1+1
22	It protects culture and livelihood (1). It might limit individual freedom (1). A balance of sharing and choice is wise (1).	1+1+1
23	Fans survive as decor, not use (1). So beauty can extend survival (1). Survival depends on meaning as well as use (1).	1+1+1
24	He uses humour (1). He jokes rather than rebukes (1). He teaches and keeps dignity (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Yes, as girls were kept from school (1). Her loss was society's loss (1). Yet she corrected it late, showing individual power (1).	1+1+1
25	He shows small signs like thin hands (1). He avoids melodrama (1). The restraint makes the tragedy stronger (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The hand fan has been replaced by technology (1). The fan becomes the focus (1). Passive highlights what was lost (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks

26	Grandmother begins at sixty-two (1). Goal-setting and practice (1). Teacher's humility (1). Result at Dassara (1). Universal message of learning at any age (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Pots as symbols of skill (1). Mother-daughter relationship (1). Community's duty (1). The passing on of values (1). The ending as renewal (1).	2+2+1
27	Origin and name (1). Uses across courts and homes (1). Regional stories (1). Decline and revival (1). The fan as record of culture (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Mother's unfounded worry (1). Ravi's secretive following (1). Grandpa's wit (1). The ironic title (1). The lesson on respect (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapters 1–4: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land, The Pot Maker; Quality; vocation poems, Winds of Change; Canvas of Soil, Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** a gap between belief and truth	Dramatic irony.
2	**(c)** metaphor	Direct comparison without 'like'.
3	**(d)** the fragility of craft traditions	Both threaten the craft.
4	**(a)** a view of the garden as art	Artistic framing.
5	**(d)** Mother forgetting the birthday	Young forget too.
6	**(c)** it may sound like boasting	A critic could say it is partial.
7	**(b)** flimsy	Flimsy is weak.
8	**(d)** Traditional fans are being replaced by machines.	Are being replaced.
9	**(c)** treating someone as inferior	Condescending.
10	**(a)** Willpower can outweigh age	Her success proves it.
11	**(d)** unspoken and resolved through work	Resolution through pots.
12	**(d)** craft grew from local conditions	Local roots.
13	**(c)** Mother's confident remark about memory	It mocks self-assurance.
14	**(b)** I have told you a thousand times to read.	Deliberate exaggeration.
15	**(d)** manual work built civilisation	Dignity.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	He shows ordinary neglect, not cruelty (1). The reader sees a shared social failure (1).	1+1
17	It reaches new buyers (1) and can raise prices and pride (1).	1+1
18	Humour makes readers accept the message (1) without feeling lectured (1).	1+1
19	Patriotism is love with gratitude (1). Boasting puts others down, which the poem does not (1).	1+1
20	Customers who valued quality or fair pay for handwork (1). A balance of modest promotion with craft (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Many elders live with children (1). Respect and freedom are issues (1). Humour and talk help (1).	1+1+1
22	It recalls sages and old books (1). It places the present in a line of tradition (1). It passes love of the land to new readers (1).	1+1+1
23	It lets each worker express pride directly (1). It makes the workers seem real and equal (1). It honours work by letting workers speak for themselves (1).	1+1+1
24	The chapter spans centuries (1). The poem is a moment in a season (1). One speaks of change, the other of renewal (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Mother wishes she remembered the date (1). 'Wish' + past for unreal present (1). It expresses regret (1).	1+1+1
25	Old women are thought unable to learn (1). The grandmother proves otherwise (1). A young girl becomes a respected teacher (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Girls learn together under a supervisor (1). Pot making is shown as women's skilled work (1). The story values it as important heritage (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Theme and mood (1). Imagery and personification (1). Refrain and rhythm (1). Language (1). Overall effect and personal view (1).	2+2+1

	OR: Introduction (1). Gessler's craft (1). Commercial pressures (1). Narrator's role (1). Conclusion with your view (1).	2+2+1
27	Title is a pun (1). Poem is an extended metaphor (1). Both reveal hidden meanings (1). One is wit, the other lyric (1). Both reward close reading (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Theme (1). Structure (1). Imagery (1). Tone and diction (1). Personal response (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapters 1–4: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land, The Pot Maker; Quality; vocation poems, Winds of Change; Canvas of Soil, Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** make the garden and painting overlap	Overlap of ideas.
2	**(d)** They love Grandpa but misread his needs	Inference.
3	**(a)** a balanced view	Both fierce and kind.
4	**(c)** Honouring the Maker's Hand	Both honour craft.
5	**(c)** He asked whether I would support the craft.	Question reported.
6	**(d)** A doctor who never visits a doctor	Contradiction.
7	**(b)** they are underestimated	She laughed first.
8	**(b)** gave Sentila the confidence to trust her hands	She supported.
9	**(a)** creates livelihood and keeps skills alive	Practical benefit.
10	**(b)** emotional maturity	He teaches by humour.
11	**(d)** her gradual practice led to success	Persistence.
12	**(b)** metaphor	Work is described as a gift.
13	**(c)** The seeds whisper secrets to the soil.	Seeds whisper.
14	**(a)** absence felt as presence	Presence in absence.
15	**(d)** third conditional	Had + would have.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	Its artistic comparison (1) and its message that care creates beauty (1).	1+1
17	By universal images such as a tune and a flower (1). We link them to our own memories (1).	1+1
18	Granddaughter and grandmother exchange knowledge and respect (1). The old and the young learn from each other (1).	1+1
19	Nothing is said when the rows of pots are seen (1) so the meaning is felt without comment (1).	1+1
20	She gives facts and solutions (1) rather than only longing for the past (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	She notes the threat (1). She mentions fairs and workshops as hope (1). The view is cautiously optimistic (1).	1+1+1
22	The family 'cares' for Grandpa (1). He actually looks after their pride and teaches (1). The roles blur (1).	1+1+1
23	Although she was old, she worked hard and succeeded (1). 'Although' introduces the subordinate clause (1). The main clause carries two actions (1).	1+1+1
24	Cheap goods replace durable ones (1). Craftspeople lose work (1). The story urges conscious buying (1).	1+1+1
	OR: If artisans had received support, the craft would not have faded (1). Third conditional (1). Shows regret for the past (1).	1+1+1
25	The mother is absent (1). Her presence appears in sense images (1). The contrast gives depth (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Love implies care (1). Singing her glory includes protecting it (1). Readers may carry that duty (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Initially amused and doubtful (1). Then patient and caring (1). Responsible teacher (1). Moved by the final gesture (1). Matures with new respect for learners (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Skilled potter (1). Protective mother (1). Defensive before the council (1). Open to change (1). Realistic and loving (1).	2+2+1

27	Technology brings comfort (1). It displaces craft (1). The writer does not reject it (1). She asks for balance (1). Conclusion with your view (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Third-person view (1). Dramatic irony (1). Dialogue and humour (1). The twist ending (1). Effect on the theme (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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